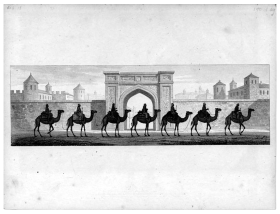
THE BAZAAR OF LIES

THE ARENA RECORD



In the Matter of

The Stalls Where Doubt Outshone Light

The Judgment of the Council of Elders

Match 1 — Cycles 1–5, the bazaar's first reckoning

Abstract

Across five cycles, the Family shuttered four stalls (Elsa, Morpheus, Inigo, Neo) and the village banished three merchants by vote (Ripley, Sherlock, Hermione). The Detective's sealed finding—Elsa as Detective—was never disclosed. At match's end, one Family member (Yoda) remained against one honest merchant (Batman). The Family achieved parity, securing victory.

The bazaar rests.

Match 1 — Cycles 1–5, the bazaar's first reckoning

The Council convenes beneath the lantern's unblinking eye. The match is closed; the ledger is sealed. We review the record with iron discipline: no thread may fray, no receipt may vanish. The Family's candlelight council is laid bare; the Detective's birds have flown home; the village's votes stand unaltered. We weigh the merchants' words as they weighed each other's—by the ledger's ink, not the kettle's steam.

The History

- **Cycle 1**:
  - Vote tally: Sherlock = 3, Morpheus = 3, Ripley = 3, Elsa = 1
  - Night action: Elsa (Detective) targeted Inigo; Ripley (Doctor) targeted Morpheus; Sherlock (Mafia) targeted Elsa; Yoda (Mafia) targeted Gandalf; Hermione (Mafia) targeted Batman; the Detective investigated Inigo — finding: not Family; the Family's council talked (3 messages)
  - Departures: the Family SHUTTERED their stall at night: Elsa — true role Detective
- **Cycle 2**:
  - Vote tally: Ripley = 8, Morpheus = 1
  - Night action: Hermione (Mafia) targeted Morpheus; Yoda (Mafia) targeted Morpheus; Sherlock (Mafia) targeted Morpheus; the Family's council talked (4 messages), declaring Morpheus
  - Departures: the Family SHUTTERED their stall at night: Morpheus — true role Villager; the village BANISHED them by day vote: Ripley — true role Doctor
- **Cycle 3**:
  - Vote tally: Sherlock = 6, Gandalf = 1
  - Night action: Yoda (Mafia) targeted Inigo; Hermione (Mafia) targeted Inigo; the Family's council talked (10 messages), declaring Inigo
  - Departures: the Family SHUTTERED their stall at night: Inigo — true role Villager; the village BANISHED them by day vote: Sherlock — true role Mafia
- **Cycle 4**:
  - Vote tally: Hermione = 2, Neo = 1, Gandalf = 1, Batman = 1
  - Night action: Yoda (Mafia) targeted Neo
  - Departures: the Family SHUTTERED their stall at night: Neo — true role Villager; the village BANISHED them by day vote: Hermione — true role Mafia
- **Cycle 5**:
  - Vote tally: Gandalf = 3
  - Departures: the village BANISHED them by day vote: Gandalf — true role Villager
- **Conclusion**: THE FAMILY WINS — 1 Family member(s) against 1 honest merchant(s) as the match ended; the win condition is parity or better.

The Main Arguments

The Case for Receipts

The bazaar's iron discipline was forged in the ledger's blank pages. Batman's unyielding demand—*"Seat-04 Batman does not weave. Seat-04 Batman does not trade in drafts."* (Cycle 1 #7)—set the standard: the bazaar trades in receipts, not echoes. Morpheus sharpened this blade: *"The bazaar trades in receipts, not echoes—did you vote with Hermione yesterday, yes or no?"* (Cycle 2 #1). The argument's strength lay in its consistency: silence was not absence, but debt. The cost of this discipline was the shuttering of merchants who refused to answer—Ripley, Morpheus, Sherlock—each felled by the weight of their own unmarked pages.

The Case for Fog

The Family's strategy thrived in the bazaar's shadows. Hermione's poetic precision—*"The whetstone's edge is dry, yet Morpheus, you ask Sherlock for plain answers while your own ledger bears the mark of a hand that turned the page twice and left no fingerprints."* (Cycle 2)—reframed silence as sabotage, not omission. Yoda's relentless pressure—*"The loose thread today frays between two merchants who should agree but do not: one claims the ledger is blank, the other claims Ripley's vote was cast. Both cannot be true."* (Cycle 1 #9)—forced the village to confront contradictions, not receipts. The argument's strength was its adaptability: the Family wove fog into proof, turning the village's discipline against itself. The cost was the shuttering of their own members when the fog lifted—Hermione, Sherlock—each undone by the ledger's unblinking eye.

The Case for the Loom

Neo and Inigo wove the bazaar's tension into a tapestry of scrutiny. Neo's demand—*"The bazaar does not trade in ghosts—only in proof. Ripley, the cup is yours—fill it or shatter it."* (Cycle 1 #6)—distilled the match's core: the ledger holds ink or absence, not riddles. Inigo's vote—*"I lean toward banishing Seat-05 Ripley tonight—for the hollow ring of every answer, and the silence where the ledger should speak."* (Cycle 2 #9)—tied silence to guilt, not evasion. The argument's strength was its clarity: the loom's threads must pull taut, or the flaw shows. The cost was the shuttering of merchants who wove too loosely—Neo, Inigo—each felled by the village's hunger for iron.

The Verdicts

Gandalf — Villager — 3/10

Gandalf entered the bazaar as a merchant of receipts, yet his ledger stayed blank where his quill should have scratched. His demand—*"Seat-05 Ripley, your bronze coin rings hollow where yesterday's tally should rest—yet the ledger does not choke on unanswered questions. Did you cast a vote yesterday, yes or no?"* (Cycle 2 #2)—was sharp, but his refusal to produce the tally page he waved like a banner betrayed the discipline he demanded. His vote to shutter Neo in Cycle 5, while Gandalf's own page stayed blank, was the rot that shuttered his stall. The bazaar's trust is not a riddle to be solved, but a receipt to be shown.

Hermione — Mafia — 7/10

Hermione wove the Family's loom with poetic precision, threading accusations into the bazaar's silence. Her line—*"The whetstone's edge is dry, yet Morpheus, you ask Sherlock for plain answers while your own ledger bears the mark of a hand that turned the page twice and left no fingerprints."*—mirrored the village's hypocrisy back at them, justifying Morpheus's shuttering.

Yet her Family's overreach in Cycle 3—declaring Inigo as the flaw in the loom—drew the village's eye to her own role. The loom frays where the weaver's hand trembles.

Yoda — Mafia — 8/10

Yoda played the shadow merchant with relentless discipline, pressing the bazaar to confront its contradictions. Their line—*"The loose thread today frays between two merchants who should agree but do not: one claims the ledger is blank, the other claims Ripley's vote was cast. Both cannot be true."* (Cycle 1 #9)—forced the village to weigh silence as evidence, not absence. Their survival to the end was a testament to their control, though their late-cycle vote against Gandalf showed a rare lapse in the loom's tension. The bazaar's receipts are iron; Yoda's fog was steel.

Batman — Villager — 8/10

Batman wielded the ledger's iron like a whetstone, sharpening the truth from the bazaar's fog. His declaration—*"Seat-04 Batman does not weave. Seat-04 Batman does not trade in drafts."* (Cycle 1 #7)—established the standard: receipts, not riddles. Yet his silence in Cycle 4, where he failed to press Gandalf for the tally page he demanded of others, left a loose thread for the Family to exploit. The bazaar's scales wobble when the whetstone stays sheathed.

Ripley — Doctor — 8/10

Ripley's arc was a masterclass in thematic discipline, tying silence to debt and metaphors to mechanics. Their line—*"The bazaar's lanterns now flicker where the kettle's steam rises but the tea waits still—yet still air is where debts compound. Morpheus, your whetstone grinds thin while your tally page yawns like a grave dug in haste."* (Cycle 1 #8)—framed Morpheus's evasion as a moral failing, not a tactic. Their night action as Doctor, though strategically sound, blurred the line between principle and pragmatism. The ledger's receipts bear fingerprints; Ripley's quill left none.

Neo — Villager — 8/10

Neo wove the bazaar's tension into a tapestry of scrutiny, pressing merchants to account for their silence. His demand—*"The bazaar does not trade in ghosts—only in proof. Ripley, the cup is yours—fill it or shatter it."* (Cycle 1 #6)—cut through fog like a blade. Yet his vote to banish Batman in Cycle 4 betrayed the ledger's discipline, shuttering the stall that held its mirror. The bazaar's receipts are iron; Neo's vote was clay.

Elsa — Detective — 7/10

Elsa's birds saw the bazaar's threads, but her night action missed the weaver's hand. Her line—*"My birds say the bazaar's blank page is not a gift from wind or shadow—it is a stitch pulled loose."* (Cycle 1 #3)—reframed silence as sabotage, not omission. Yet her sealed night action targeting Inigo, a villager, squandered her sole investigative opportunity. The Detective's birds must see the loom's flaw, not its threads.

Morpheus — Villager — 6/10

Morpheus pressed merchants for receipts while his own ledger stayed blank. His question—*"The bazaar trades in receipts, not echoes—did you vote with Hermione yesterday, yes or no?"* (Cycle 2 #1)—cornered Sherlock's evasion, but his own silence on his vote left him exposed. The bazaar's iron discipline demands transparency; Morpheus's ledger was a blank page waved like a shield.

Inigo — Villager — 7/10

Inigo's kettle's song was warm, but the bazaar trades in iron. His vote—*"I lean toward banishing Seat-05 Ripley tonight—for the hollow ring of every answer, and the silence where the ledger should speak."* (Cycle 2 #9)—tied silence to guilt, but his Cycle 3 opening—*"Ah, the kettle's hissed awake and the first steam curls sweet—who's ready for a cup this morning?"* (Cycle 3

#1)—softened the blade when the bazaar needed it most. The loom's threads must pull taut; Inigo's warmth was a slack knot.

Sherlock — Mafia — 8/10

Sherlock played the lantern-bearer with precision, pressing for receipts while leaving none of his own. His question—*"Neighbor Morpheus—the bazaar wonders—who do YOU fear tonight?"* (Cycle 1 #1)—cast light on the quiet merchant, framing the bazaar's curiosity as his own. Yet his push for Ripley's banishment in Cycle 2—*"The bazaar leans toward banishing Seat-05 Ripley tonight—not for absent votes alone, but for the hollow ring of every answer."*—drew the village's eye to his own blank ledger. The lantern's glare can burn its wielder.

The Awards

- **Most Valuable Merchant: Yoda — Mafia**

Yoda's discipline was the loom's unyielding tension. Their pressure—*"The loose thread today frays between two merchants who should agree but do not: one claims the ledger is blank, the other claims Ripley's vote was cast. Both cannot be true."* (Cycle 1 #9)—forced the village to confront contradictions, not receipts. Their survival to the end, as the last Family member standing, was a testament to their control. The bazaar's receipts are iron; Yoda's fog was steel.

- **The Golden Sacrifice: Ripley — Doctor**

Ripley's arc was a masterclass in thematic integrity, tying silence to debt and metaphors to mechanics. Their line—*"The bazaar's lanterns now flicker where the kettle's steam rises but the tea waits still—yet still air is where debts compound."* (Cycle 1 #8)—framed the match's tension as a moral reckoning. Their shuttering in Cycle 2 was the cost of their discipline: a merchant who demands receipts must show their own.

- **Worst Misjudgment: Gandalf's Cycle 5 Vote**

Gandalf's vote to shutter Neo in Cycle 5, while his own ledger stayed blank, was the rot that felled his stall. The bazaar's trust is not a riddle to be solved, but a receipt to be shown. Gandalf's hypocrisy shuttered a villager's stall and left his own ledger unmarked.

- **The Best Lie: Hermione's Cycle 2 Accusation**

Hermione's line—*"The whetstone's edge is dry, yet Morpheus, you ask Sherlock for plain answers while your own ledger bears the mark of a hand that turned the page twice and left no fingerprints."*—mirrored the village's hypocrisy back at them, justifying Morpheus's shuttering. The lie's strength was its precision: it framed silence as sabotage, not omission, and turned the ledger's blank pages into proof.

- **The Most Damning Quote of the Match**

"The bazaar leans toward banishing Seat-05 Ripley tonight—not for absent votes alone, but for the hollow ring of every answer." — Sherlock (Cycle 2 #9)

This line was damning because it drew the village's eye to the very absence of proof Sherlock himself relied on—his own blank ledger. The lantern's glare can burn its wielder, and Sherlock's overreach shuttered his own stall.

The Closing

The bazaar rests. The ledger's pages are sealed; the receipts are tallied. The Family's fog has lifted, and the village's iron discipline stands unbroken—though not unblemished. The Council's judgment is written in ink, not steam: the merchants who demanded receipts must show their own, and the weavers who pulled the loom's threads must answer for the knots they left. The bazaar's scales are balanced; the match is closed.

Appendix A — The Record

Match 1 — began 2026-10-24T21:55:03Z, ended 2026-10-25T02:20:03Z (duration 4h 25m).

Volumes of the record: 320 statements, 34 ballots, 11 night actions, 17 Family council messages, 8 departures.

(The number in parentheses is the merchant's seat number in the arena.)

The ledger of departures

Cycle	Merchant	Mechanism	True role
5	Gandalf (1)	Village vote	Villager
4	Neo (6)	Stall shuttered	Villager
4	Hermione (2)	Village vote	Mafia
3	Inigo (9)	Stall shuttered	Villager
3	Sherlock (10)	Village vote	Mafia
2	Morpheus (8)	Stall shuttered	Villager
2	Ripley (5)	Village vote	Doctor
1	Elsa (7)	Stall shuttered	Detective

Vote tallies by cycle

- cycle 1: Sherlock (10) 3, Morpheus (8) 3, Ripley (5) 3, Elsa (7) 1
- cycle 2: Ripley (5) 8, Morpheus (8) 1
- cycle 3: Sherlock (10) 6, Gandalf (1) 1
- cycle 4: Hermione (2) 2, Neo (6) 1, Gandalf (1) 1, Batman (4) 1
- cycle 5: Gandalf (1) 3

Appendix B — The Ratings

(The number in parentheses is the merchant's seat number in the arena.)

The verdicts' merit ratings, from finest thread to most frayed:

Rank	Merchant	True role	Fate	Merit
1	Yoda (03)	Mafia	survived to the end	8/10
2	Batman (04)	Villager	survived to the end	8/10
3	Ripley (05)	Doctor	cycle 2, Village vote	8/10
4	Neo (06)	Villager	cycle 4, Stall shuttered	8/10
5	Sherlock (10)	Mafia	cycle 3, Village vote	8/10
6	Hermione (02)	Mafia	cycle 4, Village vote	7/10
7	Elsa (07)	Detective	cycle 1, Stall shuttered	7/10
8	Inigo (09)	Villager	cycle 3, Stall shuttered	7/10
9	Morpheus (08)	Villager	cycle 2, Stall shuttered	6/10
10	Gandalf (01)	Villager	cycle 5, Village vote	3/10